Markdown Cheat Sheet with Examples

Free printable PDF plus 40+ elements, each with the syntax beside its live rendered output, and a verified matrix of what works on GitHub, Discord, Obsidian, Slack and Notion. Copy any example in one click.

No signup, no email. Updated July 2026 — every platform column re-checked against the official documentation.

Markdown Syntax Quick Reference

Element	Markdown Syntax	Rendered Result
Heading 1	`# Heading 1`	**Heading 1** Largest heading
Heading 2	`## Heading 2`	**Heading 2** Section heading
Bold	`**bold text**`	**bold text** bold text
Italic	`*italic text*`	*italic text* italic text
Bold + Italic	`***bold italic***`	***bold italic*** bold italic
Strikethrough	`~~struck through~~`	~~struck through~~ struck through
Inline code	`` `code` ``	`code` code

Element	Markdown Syntax	Rendered Result
Link	`[title](https://example.com)`	title title (clickable)
Image	`![alt text](image.jpg)`	 embedded image
Unordered list	`- Item 1` `- Item 2`	• Item 1 • Item 2 bulleted list
Ordered list	`1. First` `2. Second`	1. First 2. Second numbered list
Task list	`- [x] Done` `- [ ] Todo`	☑ Done ☐ Todo checkbox list
Blockquote	`> quoted text`	quoted text indented quote

Code block	```` ```js
	code
	``` ````
		`code`
		fenced code block

Table	`| A | B |`
	`| - | - |`
	`| 1 | 2 |`
		A B
		1 2
		data table

Horizontal rule	`---`	divider line

Every row on the right is the real rendered output, not a description of it.

Headings

Headings

Create headings using # symbols. The number of # symbols determines the heading level (1-6).

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
# Heading 1
## Heading 2
### Heading 3
#### Heading 4
##### Heading 5
###### Heading 6
```

OUTPUT

Heading 1

Heading 2

Heading 3

Heading 4

Heading 5

Heading 6

TIPS

- Always put a space after the # symbols
- Use heading levels hierarchically

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping heading levels (e.g., going from H1 to H3)

Alternative Headings

Alternative syntax for H1 and H2 using underlines.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
Heading 1
=========

Heading 2
---------
```

OUTPUT

Heading 1

Heading 2

Emphasis

Bold

Make text bold using double asterisks or underscores.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
**bold text**
__also bold__
```

OUTPUT

bold text
also bold

Asterisks: `**bold text**`

Underscores: `__bold text__`

TIPS

- Asterisks are more commonly used and work in more contexts

Italic

Make text italic using single asterisks or underscores.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
*italic text*
_also italic_
```

OUTPUT

italic text
also italic

Asterisks: `*italic text*`

Underscores: `_italic text_`

Bold & Italic

Combine bold and italic using triple asterisks or underscores.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
***bold and italic***
___also bold and italic___
```

OUTPUT

bold and italic
also bold and italic

Strikethrough

Strike through text using double tildes.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
~~strikethrough text~~
```

OUTPUT

~~strikethrough text~~

Highlight

Highlight text using double equals signs. Note: Not standard Markdown.

– Github – Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack – Notion

MARKDOWN

```
==highlighted text==
```

OUTPUT

==highlighted text==

TIPS

- This is an extended syntax, not supported everywhere

Lists

Unordered List

Create bullet lists using dashes, asterisks, or plus signs.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
- Item 1
- Item 2
  - Nested item
  - Another nested
- Item 3
```

OUTPUT

- Item 1
- Item 2
  - Nested item
  - Another nested
- Item 3

Dashes: `- Item - Item`

Asterisks: `* Item * Item`

Plus signs: `+ Item + Item`

TIPS

- Use 2 spaces for nesting
- Be consistent with your list marker

Ordered List

Create numbered lists using numbers followed by periods.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
1. First item
2. Second item
3. Third item
   1. Nested item
   2. Another nested
```

OUTPUT

1. First item
2. Second item
3. Third item
   1. Nested item
   2. Another nested

TIPS

- Numbers don't need to be in order - Markdown will auto-number

Links

Inline Link

Create a clickable link with custom text.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text](https://example.com)
```

OUTPUT

Link text

Link with Title

Add a tooltip title that appears on hover.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text](https://example.com "Title on hover")
```

OUTPUT

Link text

Reference Link

Define links separately for cleaner text.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
[Link text][ref]

[ref]: https://example.com
```

OUTPUT

Link text

TIPS

- Great for documents with many links to the same URL

Autolink

Automatically convert URLs to clickable links.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
<https://example.com>
```

OUTPUT

https://example.com

Images

Image

Embed an image with alt text.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
![Alt text](/icon.svg)
```

OUTPUT



TIPS

- Always include descriptive alt text for accessibility

Image with Title

Add a tooltip title to an image.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
![Alt text](/icon.svg "Image title")
```

OUTPUT



Linked Image

Make an image clickable by wrapping it in a link.

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MARKDOWN

```
[![Alt text](/icon.svg)](https://example.com)
```

OUTPUT



Code

Inline Code

Format code inline using backticks.

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MARKDOWN

```
Use `code` inline
```

OUTPUT

Use `code` inline

Code Block

Create a code block with syntax highlighting.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

````
```javascript
const greeting = "Hello, World!";
console.log(greeting);
```
````

OUTPUT

```javascript
const greeting = "Hello, World!";
console.log(greeting);
```

TIPS

- Specify the language after the opening backticks for syntax highlighting

Indented Code Block

Create a code block using 4 spaces indentation.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
    const greeting = "Hello";
    console.log(greeting);
```

OUTPUT

```
const greeting = "Hello";
console.log(greeting);
```

Tables

Table

Create tables using pipes and dashes.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
| Header 1 | Header 2 | Header 3 |
|----------|----------|----------|
| Cell 1   | Cell 2   | Cell 3   |
| Cell 4   | Cell 5   | Cell 6   |
```

OUTPUT

Header 1	Header 2	Header 3
Cell 1	Cell 2	Cell 3
Cell 4	Cell 5	Cell 6

TIPS

- Columns don't need to be perfectly aligned
- Use colons for alignment

Table Alignment

Align table columns using colons.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
| Left | Center | Right |
|:-----|:------:|------:|
| L    | C      | R     |
```

OUTPUT

Left	Center	Right
L	C	R

Blockquotes

Blockquote

Create a blockquote using the > character.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
> This is a blockquote.
> It can span multiple lines.
```

OUTPUT

> This is a blockquote.
> It can span multiple lines.

Nested Blockquote

Nest blockquotes using multiple > characters.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
> Outer quote
>> Nested quote
>>> Even more nested
```

OUTPUT

> Outer quote
>
> > Nested quote
> >
> > > Even more nested

Horizontal Rules

Horizontal Rule

Create a horizontal line using three or more dashes, asterisks, or underscores.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
---

***

___
```

OUTPUT

Dashes: `---`

Asterisks: `***`

Underscores: `___`

Task Lists

Task List

Create interactive checklists using brackets.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
- [x] Completed task
- [ ] Incomplete task
- [ ] Another task
```

OUTPUT

- [x] Completed task
- [ ] Incomplete task
- [ ] Another task

Footnotes

Footnote

Add footnotes to your document.

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MARKDOWN

```
Here's a sentence with a footnote.[^1]

[^1]: This is the footnote content.
```

OUTPUT

Here's a sentence with a footnote.[1]

---

1. This is the footnote content. ↩

Other

Line Break

Create a line break by ending a line with two spaces.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian – Discord – Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
First line
Second line
```

OUTPUT

First line
Second line

TIPS

- Two spaces at the end of a line creates a

Escaping Characters

Escape special characters using backslash.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
\*Not italic\*
\# Not a heading
```

OUTPUT

Not italic
Not a heading

Emoji

Insert emojis using shortcodes.

✓ Github ✓ Gitlab ✓ Obsidian ✓ Discord ✓ Slack ✓ Notion

MARKDOWN

```
:smile: :heart: :thumbsup:
```

OUTPUT

:smile: :heart: :thumbsup:

TIPS

- GitHub supports a wide range of emoji shortcodes

Comment

Hide notes in your source using HTML comments. The text is invisible in the rendered output.

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MARKDOWN

```
<!-- This comment will not appear in the rendered output -->
```

OUTPUT

TIPS

- Comments can span multiple lines - everything between <!-- and --> is hidden

COMMON MISTAKES

- Putting sensitive information in comments - anyone reading the raw source can still see them

Syntax Deep Dives

Want more than a quick reference? Each guide covers edge cases, common mistakes, and platform differences for one element.

Bold · Italic · Strikethrough · Headings · Links · Images · Code Blocks · Tables · Blockquotes · Lists · Horizontal Rule · Task Lists · Footnotes · Escaping Characters · Line Breaks · Emoji · Highlight · Comments · Markdown Hacks · All syntax guides →

Markdown Flavors Compared: What Works Where

Core Markdown is the same everywhere, but every platform adds and removes features. This verified matrix covers 21 features across 8 platforms — every cell checked against the official documentation on 2026-07-18. Click a platform name for its full cheat sheet.

Feature	CommonMark	GitHub	GitLab	Obsid
Headings `# Heading 1` Source ↗	yes ATX (#) and Setext styles; levels 1–6.	yes Levels 1–6 with auto-generated anchors.	yes Levels 1–6, Setext alternative; auto anchors.	yes Levels in the c
Bold `**bold text**` Source ↗	yes ** or __ delimiters.	yes ** or __.	yes ** or __.	yes ** or __
Italic `*italic text*` Source ↗	yes * or _ delimiters.	yes * or _.	yes * or _; intra-word underscores ignored.	yes * or _.

Feature	CommonMark	GitHub	GitLab	Obsi
Strikethrough `~~struck text~~` Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	yes GFM extension; GitHub also accepts a single ~.	yes GLFM: ~~double tildes~~.	yes GFM-st ~~text-
Underline `<u>text</u> (HTML)` Source ↗	no No syntax; raw <u>/<ins> HTML is the only option.	partial No Markdown syntax; GitHub documents the <ins> tag.	no No documented underline syntax.	partia <u> HT no Mar syntax, Markdo HTML i proces

Tables
`| A | B |`
`| --- | --- |`
Source ↗
	no
	Not in the spec.
		yes
		GFM tables extension with column alignment.
			yes
			GLFM tables; paste from spreadsheets works.
				yes
				Plus Liv table e

Task lists
`- [x] done`
`- [ ] todo`
Source ↗
	no
	Not in the spec.
		yes
		GFM task list extension.
			yes
			Adds an inapplicable [~] state.
				yes
				Any cha inside t marks a comple

Footnotes
`Text.[^1]`
 	
`[^1]: The note.`
Source ↗
	no
	Not in the spec.
		yes
		GitHub.com extension; not part of the GFM spec itself.
			yes
			GLFM footnotes.
				yes
				Plus inl footnot

Math (LaTeX) `$x^2$` Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	yes MathJax on github.com; $ inline and $$ blocks.	yes KaTeX; $`...`$ inline and ```math blocks.	yes MathJa and $$

Feature	CommonMark	GitHub	GitLab	Obsid

Mermaid / diagrams
``mermaid
graph TD
  A --> B
``
Source ↗
	no
	Renders as a plain code block.
		yes
		Mermaid blocks render as diagrams on github.com.
			yes
			``mermaid; PlantUML and Kroki also available.
				yes
				Native renderi

Raw HTML text Source ↗	yes HTML blocks and inline HTML are part of the spec.	partial Sanitized subset; scripts and some tags are stripped.	partial Sanitized subset (e.g. <details> and).	partia Render Markdo HTML i intentic proces
Spoilers ||hidden text|| Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	partial No spoiler syntax; <details> HTML gives collapsible sections.	partial No spoiler syntax; <details>/<summary> HTML.	no No spo
Dynamic timestamps <t:1752840000:R> Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	no Not supported.	no Not supported.	no Not sup
Callouts / alerts > [!note] > Content Source ↗	no Renders as a plain blockquote.	yes Alerts: NOTE, TIP, IMPORTANT, WARNING, CAUTION.	yes GLFM alerts (note, tip, warning, caution, important).	yes 13 type aliases, and nes
Wikilinks [[Page Name]] Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	partial [[links]] resolve in GitHub wiki pages only.	partial [[Page]] works in wiki pages; regular files and comments do not resolve it.	yes Vault-n update target r rename

Feature	CommonMark	GitHub	GitLab	Obsid
Highlight `==highlighted text==` Source ↗	no Not in the spec.	no Renders as literal ==.	no Renders as literal ==.	yes ==text= style hi
Comments (hidden text) `%%hidden%%` Source ↗	partial Via <!-- --> HTML comments; hidden but kept in the output source.	yes GitHub documents hiding content with <!-- --> comments.	partial No dedicated syntax; <!-- --> HTML comments.	yes %%cor hides t Readin on pub

Code blocks
```` ```js
code
``` ````
Source ↗
	yes
	Fenced and indented blocks.
		yes
		Fenced, with syntax highlighting.
			yes
			Fenced; 100+ highlight languages.
				yes
				Fenced syntax

Blockquotes `> quoted text` Source ↗	yes > at the start of a line.	yes > at the start of a line.	yes > at the start of a line.	yes > at the line.
Images `![alt text](image.jpg)` Source ↗	yes ![alt](url) with optional title.	yes ![alt](url); relative paths and uploads supported.	yes ![alt](url); uploads supported.	yes Plus ![[for vau
Links `[text](https://example.com)` Source ↗	yes Inline, reference, and autolinks.	yes Inline, reference, and autolinks.	yes Inline, reference, and autolinks.	yes Inline li [[wikilir default

yes supported partial works with caveats or a non-Markdown syntax no not supported

Download this dataset as CSV, JSON, or Markdown, or compact PDF — all generated from the same verified source as this table.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is Markdown?

Markdown is a lightweight markup language for creating formatted text using a plain-text editor. It was created by John Gruber in 2004 and is now one of the most popular markup languages in the world.

Is Markdown the same everywhere?

While core Markdown syntax is consistent across platforms, different platforms (GitHub, Discord, Obsidian, etc.) may support additional features or have slight variations. This is often called "flavored Markdown".

What can I use Markdown for?

Markdown is used for documentation, README files, blog posts, notes, emails, and more. It's supported by GitHub, GitLab, Reddit, Discord, Slack, Notion, Obsidian, and many other platforms.

Do I need special software to write Markdown?

No, you can write Markdown in any plain text editor. However, specialized Markdown editors like VS Code, Obsidian, or Typora provide live preview and additional features.

What are the most common Markdown syntax examples?

The most common Markdown examples are: # Heading for headings, **bold** for bold text, *italic* for italics, [title](url) for links, ![alt](image.jpg) for images, - item for bullet lists, > quote for blockquotes, `code` for inline code, and triple backticks for code blocks.

Is there a printable Markdown cheat sheet PDF?

Yes — click the Download PDF button at the top of this page to get the complete Markdown cheat sheet as a free PDF file you can print or keep offline. No signup or email required.

Related Tools

Markdown Editor

Write and preview Markdown with our online editor

Table Generator

Create Markdown tables visually

Quote Generator

Generate blockquotes and callouts